

Ask Claude to Explain Anything

No question is too basic. No topic too late to learn.

"Finally understand the thing you've been nodding along to for years."

Ejoshi

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THE PROBLEM

We all have a list. Inflation. How a mortgage actually works. What blockchain is, really. Why planes stay in the air. How vaccines work. What the Federal Reserve does. Things we've heard about a thousand times, nodded along to, and never actually sat down to understand. Not because we're not curious. Because asking feels embarrassing at this point. "Shouldn't I already know this?"

Google isn't always the answer. The first result is either too technical, too shallow, or written for someone who already knows the basics. Video explainers take 12 minutes to get to the point. And there's no one to ask follow-up questions.

Claude is the one place where no question is embarrassing. You can ask it to explain anything from scratch, at exactly the level you need, with examples that make sense for your life. You can ask it again if the first answer didn't click. You can say "I still don't get it" and it will find another way in. This kit gives you the prompt that makes it work every time.

THE CLAUDE PROMPT

Copy this prompt word for word. Fill in the one bracket. Run it at claude.ai — free, no account needed.

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Please explain [thing I don't really understand] to me.
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I want you to:
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- Start with the simplest possible version
(assume I know nothing)
- Use a concrete analogy I can picture
- Tell me the one thing that clicks everything else
into place
- Check if I got it by asking me one follow-up question

HOW TO FILL IT IN

→ **[thing I don't really understand]** — state it plainly. "How a mortgage works," "what inflation actually means," "why the stock market goes up and down."

→ Don't overthink the wording. Claude reads intent, not perfect grammar.

→ The four-part structure forces Claude to teach — not just dump information.

→ After Claude answers, try answering its follow-up question. That's where the learning locks in.

The question: *"Please explain how a mortgage actually works to me."*

Simplest version: You want to buy a house but don't have all the money. A bank gives you the money today — and you pay it back a little at a time every month for the next 15 to 30 years. In exchange, the bank charges you extra (called interest) for lending you the money. The house is the collateral — if you stop paying, the bank can take it.

The analogy: Think of it like a very long layaway plan — except the store charges you rent on the money until you've paid it all back. Every month you're paying back a piece of what you borrowed, plus the cost of borrowing it.

The thing that clicks everything into place: Amortization. In the early years of your mortgage, almost all of each payment goes to interest — not to paying down the loan itself. Only toward the end do you start paying mostly principal. That's why paying a little extra in year one matters so much.

Claude's follow-up: *"What do you think happens to your monthly mortgage payment if interest rates go up after you've already locked in your rate — and why might that matter to someone buying a house right now?"*

YOUR TURN

Pick the one thing from your mental list — the concept you've been nodding along to for years. The thing you'd be slightly embarrassed to admit you don't fully get. Open Claude. Ask today. The relief of actually understanding something is immediate.

Stuck on what to ask? Start here: "How does compound interest work?" "What actually happens when you file taxes?" "Why do some medications need a prescription?" Any of these will get you started — and Claude will make them click.

Try it free at ejoshi.ai

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